

BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon

The Question That Unlocked a Legacy

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** 1 Kings 3:5–14; 2 Chronicles 1:7–12; 1 Kings 4:29–30

 **Key Verse:** 1 Kings 3:9 (WEB)

“Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this your great people?”

Appetizer — 1 Kings 3:5–7 (WEB)

⁵ In Gibeon Yahweh appeared to Solomon in a dream by night; and God said, “Ask for what you want me to give you.” ⁶ Solomon said, “You have shown to your servant David my father great loving kindness, according as he walked before you in truth, righteousness, and uprightness of heart with you. You have kept for him this great loving kindness, that you have given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is today.

⁷ Now, Yahweh my God, you have made your servant king instead of David my father. I am just a little child. I don’t know how to go out or come in.

When God met Solomon in Gibeon, He didn’t start with a demand—He started with an invitation. Solomon could have asked for power, revenge, or riches. Instead, his first instinct was to talk with God about how to lead well. Before crowns and kingdoms, God tested the posture of his heart.

CST Reflection

Before greatness begins, God often tests the posture of the heart. When God hands us a “blank check” moment, what we ask for reveals what we truly value—comfort, control, or kingdom wisdom.

Reflection Question

When God gives you a blank check of opportunity, what would your prayer reveal about your heart’s priorities?

Main Course

Bite 1 — God Is Pleased With the Request, 1 Kings 3:10–11 (WEB)

¹⁰ This request pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing. ¹¹ God said to him, “Because you have asked this thing, and have not asked for yourself long life, nor have asked riches for yourself, nor have asked the life of your enemies, but have asked for yourself understanding to discern justice,

Solomon could have used prayer as a way to secure more comfort for himself. Instead, he asked for an understanding heart to serve God’s people well. God was pleased, not because the words sounded spiritual, but because the request was selfless and aligned with His purposes.

CST

True prayer doesn’t manipulate—it aligns. Solomon’s request pleased God because it flowed from a heart that valued wisdom to serve over wealth to be seen.

Reflect:

How might your prayer life change if you sought God’s heart before His hand?

Bite 2 — Wisdom Before Wealth, 2 Chronicles 1:11–12 (WEB)

¹¹ God said to Solomon, “Because this was in your heart, and you have not asked riches, wealth, honor, or the life of those who hate you, nor yet have you asked for long life; but have asked for wisdom and knowledge for yourself, that you may judge my people, over whom I have made you king, ¹²therefore wisdom and knowledge is granted to you. I will give you riches, wealth, and honor, such as none of the kings have had who have been before you, and none after you will have.”

God granted Solomon what he asked for—wisdom and understanding—and then added what he didn’t ask for: riches, wealth, and honor. When wisdom comes first, blessings can follow without becoming idols. God can trust us with more when our heart is set on serving His people instead of promoting ourselves.

CST Reflection

God rewards those who seek understanding before abundance. When you desire wisdom more than you desire status, you make room for God to add what you never thought to ask for.

Reflect:

Where in your life do you feel pressure to chase “riches and honor” instead of asking first for wisdom to serve well?



Bite 3 — A Legacy That Starts in Prayer, 1 Kings 4:29–30 (WEB)

“God gave Solomon wisdom and understanding exceeding much, and very great understanding, even as the sand that is on the seashore. Solomon’s wisdom excelled the wisdom of all the children of the east, and all the wisdom of Egypt.”

Solomon’s wisdom became his reputation. People knew him not just for what he had, but for the way he thought, judged, and led. What began as a private conversation with God in a dream turned into a public legacy that reached the nations. Solomon’s story shows that legacy doesn’t begin on a platform—it begins in God’s presence.



Reflection

How could your private time with God today shape how people remember your life tomorrow?



Dessert — The Legacy of a Wise Heart

God gave Solomon abundant wisdom and understanding “like the sand that is on the seashore,” and his wisdom exceeded that of all the surrounding nations.

The story of Solomon reminds us that real greatness starts with a listening heart. When we ask for wisdom instead of applause, God can use our lives to bless people we may never meet.



CST Reflection

Write one sentence about the kind of spiritual legacy you want to leave.

To-Go Box

- The strength of your leadership flows from the sincerity of your prayers.
- God is pleased when you ask for wisdom to serve others well.
- Solomon’s legacy began not with a throne, but with a conversation with God.

Carry this truth into your week:

Ask God for wisdom first—then trust Him with everything else.

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for the example of Solomon’s request. Teach me to value wisdom over wealth and understanding over image. Align my heart with Your priorities so that my prayers please You. Give me an understanding heart to serve well wherever You have placed me. Let my life reflect Your wisdom and bring You honor. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Personal Prayer Space

Activity – “Wisdom First” (Fill-in-the-Blank)

Complete the statements based on today’s lesson:

1. Solomon asked God for _____ and _____ to govern His people.
2. God was pleased because Solomon did *not* ask for _____, _____, or the _____ of his enemies.
3. Solomon’s legacy teaches us that _____ comes before _____.

(Check the Appendix for answers)

Note Section— Group Discussion & Personal Study

Use this space to jot down insights, testimonies, or key points from group discussion:
